

sercon

User Manual

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sercon manual

Long-form reference for the `pkg/scriptengine` library, the `sercon` CLI, the built-in script API, and the JavaScript runtime surface that `scriptengine` exposes via `goja` and `goja_nodejs`. Examples are runnable — save snippets as `.ts` files and execute with `sercon file.ts` unless otherwise noted.

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1. Overview

`sercon` is a Go program that runs TypeScript files. It's built from two parts:

- `pkg/scriptengine` — a library you embed in your own Go code. You register Go-callable bindings, then call `Run` / `RunFile` to execute a `.ts` script that talks to them.
- `cmd/sercon` — a thin CLI built on the library, useful for ad-hoc test scripts and as a working example of every binding kind.

The runtime is pure Go: `goja` is the JS engine, `esbuild` (used as a Go library) is the TS→JS transpiler, and `goja_nodejs` provides Promises, `setTimeout`, `console`, and CommonJS `require`. No cgo, no Node.

2. Quickstart

Install:

```
go install github.com/codedeviate/sercon/cmd/sercon@latest
```

Run one of the bundled examples:

```
sercon examples/scripts/smoke.ts examples/scripts/async.ts
```

...or run them all via `make demo`. `examples/scripts/` ships a runnable `.ts` (or `.tsx`) file per feature area — `hash.ts`, `strings.ts`, `path-and-time.ts`, `default-export.ts`, `tsx-demo.ts`, and the original `smoke.ts` / `async.ts` / `hang.ts` (`hang.ts` is the timeout demo and intentionally exits non-zero).

Generate a declaration file for editor autocomplete:

```
sercon --emit-dts api.d.ts
```

Embed in your own Go program:

```
eng := scriptengine.New(scriptengine.Options{
    Timeout:    5 * time.Second,
    ScriptRoot: "./scripts",
})
eng.Register("upper", strings.ToUpper)
val, err := eng.RunFile(ctx, "scripts/main.ts")
```

3. Library API — `pkg/scriptengine`

Engine, Options, New

```
type Options struct {
    Timeout      time.Duration // wall-clock limit per Run; 0 disables
    ScriptRoot   string        // base for require/import resolution
    DisableConsole bool          // turn off the goja_nodejs console module
}

func New(opts Options) *Engine
```

`Engine` is the host of all registered bindings. Construct it once, then call `Run` / `RunFile` as many times as needed — each call gets a *fresh* `*goja.Runtime` so script state never leaks between invocations.

`ScriptRoot` defaults to the working directory at `New` time if left empty. Both `Timeout` and `ScriptRoot` can be overridden on a per-Run basis only by constructing a fresh `Engine`; see [Out-of-scope](#) for the per-Run override on the roadmap.

Registering bindings

Function	Use when...
<code>Register(name, value)</code>	The binding is a pure function, struct, or primitive that doesn't need access to the runtime.
<code>RegisterNamespace(name, members map[string]any)</code>	You want to expose <code>name.x</code> , <code>name.y</code> without defining a Go struct.
<code>RegisterConstructor(name, ctor)</code>	The binding is a Go function whose return value should be treated as a class in the emitted <code>.d.ts</code> . (Runtime semantics today are identical to <code>Register</code> ; the <code>d.ts</code> emitter is the only differentiator.)
<code>RegisterFactory(name, factory func(vm, loop) any)</code>	The binding needs the per-Run <code>*goja.Runtime</code> or <code>*eventloop.EventLoop</code> in scope (typical for Promise-returning I/O).
<code>RegisterNamespaceFactory(name, factory)</code>	Same, but the factory returns the full member map.

Example — synchronous function binding:

```
eng.Register("greet", func(name string) string { return "hi " + name })
```

Example — namespace with a sync member:

```
eng.RegisterNamespace("math2", map[string]any{
    "square": func(n float64) float64 { return n * n },
    "pi":     3.14159,
})
```

Example — async (Promise-returning) binding via `PromisifyAsync`:

```

eng.RegisterFactory("httpGet", func(vm *goja.Runtime, loop
*eventloop.EventLoop) any {
    return scriptengine.PromisifyAsync(vm, loop,
        func(ctx context.Context, call goja.FunctionCall) (map[string]any,
error) {
            url := call.Argument(0).String()
            resp, err := http.Get(url)
            if err != nil {
                return nil, err
            }
            defer resp.Body.Close()
            body, _ := io.ReadAll(resp.Body)
            return map[string]any{"status": resp.StatusCode, "body":
string(body)}, nil
        })
})

```

Run, RunFile

```

func (e *Engine) Run(ctx context.Context, name, source string, opts
...RunOption) (goja.Value, error)
func (e *Engine) RunFile(ctx context.Context, path string, opts
...RunOption) (goja.Value, error)

```

`Run` executes `source` as an entry-script TS. `name` is used in stack traces. The returned value is currently always `undefined` — top-level expression capture is on the backlog.

Both methods respect `Options.Timeout` and `ctx` cancellation, whichever fires first; the resulting error is either `ErrScriptTimeout`, `ctx.Err()`, or the underlying JS exception.

Per-Run options

```

type RunOption func(*runConfig)

func WithScriptRoot(dir string) RunOption

```

Reuse a single Engine across many scripts that each live in their own directory by passing `WithScriptRoot(dir)` to `Run` / `RunFile`. The override applies only to this call; `Options.ScriptRoot` is used for every other Run.

```

_, _ = eng.Run(ctx, "main.ts", source,
scriptengine.WithScriptRoot("/path/to/run42"))

```

Reset

```
func (e *Engine) Reset()
```

Clears every registered binding. Useful when a long-lived Engine is reused across unrelated batches of scripts that each want a clean global namespace. **Not safe to call concurrently with Run / RunFile.**

WriteTypes

```
func (e *Engine) WriteTypes(w io.Writer) error
```

Emits a `.d.ts` describing the registered surface. See section [13. Type generation](#) for what the mapping looks like.

PromisifyAsync[T] and AsyncBinding

```
type AsyncBinding struct {
    Func          func(goja.FunctionCall) goja.Value
    TSReturnType string
}

func PromisifyAsync[T any](vm *goja.Runtime, loop *eventloop.EventLoop,
    work func(ctx context.Context, call goja.FunctionCall) (T, error),
) AsyncBinding
```

`PromisifyAsync` turns blocking Go work into a JS Promise. It launches the work in a goroutine, parks a `SetTimeout` sentinel so `loop.Run` doesn't return early, and schedules the resolve/reject back onto the event loop. **Required** for any Promise-returning binding — `RunOnLoop` alone is not counted as a live job by the event loop.

`PromisifyAsync` returns an `AsyncBinding` carrier rather than the bare callback. The engine unwraps it to `.Func` at `vm.Set` time so goja's special-case detection of `func(goja.FunctionCall) goja.Value` host-callbacks still fires; the `.d.ts` emitter reads `.TSReturnType` to emit `Promise<T>` (mapped from the generic `T` via reflect at construction time) instead of the previous `unknown`. Hosts assigning the result into a `map[string]any` for `RegisterNamespace` / `RegisterNamespaceFactory` get the unwrap recursively too — no manual work required.

Version

```
import "github.com/codedeviate/sercon/pkg/scriptengine"

fmt.Println(scriptengine.Version) // "0.1.0"
```

Bumped in lockstep with the git tag.

4. CLI — sercon

```
sercon [flags] <script.ts> [script.ts ...]
sercon [flags] -                # read entry script from stdin
sercon --examples | --help | --version
```

Flag	Purpose
<code>-timeout DURATION</code>	Wall-clock limit per script (default <code>10s</code> ; <code>0</code> disables).
<code>-root DIR</code>	Override the script root for <code>require</code> / <code>import</code> resolution.
<code>-emit-dts PATH</code>	Write the example bindings' <code>.d.ts</code> to <code>PATH</code> and exit.
<code>-v</code>	Verbose: trace the rewritten entry-script JS and each module resolution to stderr; also print duration on failure.
<code>-h</code> , <code>--help</code>	In-depth colorized help.
<code>--examples</code>	In-depth colorized walkthrough of every feature.
<code>--version</code>	Print the engine version (plus goja/esbuild build-info versions).

Each positional argument is either a path to a `.ts` / `.tsx` file or `-` to read an entry script from standard input:

```
echo 'api.log(1 + 2);' | sercon -
sercon prelude.ts -          # prelude then stdin
```

Exit codes are distinct per failure type so shells can react sensibly. When several scripts run, the highest applicable code wins:

Code	Meaning
<code>0</code>	every script passed.
<code>1</code>	CLI usage error (unknown flag, missing script argument, ...).
<code>2</code>	at least one script failed to transpile — never ran.
<code>3</code>	at least one script timed out (<code>-timeout</code>) or was context-cancelled.
<code>4</code>	at least one script ran and threw a JS exception.

`-v` writes lines prefixed with `[sercon]` to stderr. The traces include the full rewritten entry-script JS (the form goja actually runs, after the ESM→CJS rewrite + async IIFE wrapper) and every module-resolution event, so debugging an unexpected resolve target or a mis-rewritten import is straightforward.

The CLI registers a single `api` namespace; see the next section.

5. Built-in script `api`

The CLI exposes the following globals to every script:


```

declare const api: {
  log(...args: unknown[]): void;

  assert: {
    equal(actual: unknown, expected: unknown, msg?: string): void;
    ok(cond: unknown, msg?: string): void;
  };

  http: {
    get(url: string): Promise<{ status: number; body: string }>;
    post(url: string, body?: string): Promise<{ status: number; body:
string }>;
  };

  time: {
    nowMs(): number;
    sleep(ms: number): Promise<void>;
    format(unixMs: number, fmt: string, tz?: string): string;
  };

  env: {
    get(name: string): string | undefined;
  };

  str: {
    trim(s: string, mask?: string): string;
    ltrim(s: string, mask?: string): string;
    rtrim(s: string, mask?: string): string;
    reverse(s: string): string;
    stripHtml(s: string): string;
    nl2br(s: string, xhtml?: boolean): string;
    br2nl(s: string): string;
    base64Encode(s: string): string;
    base64Decode(s: string): string;
    urlEncode(s: string): string;
    urlDecode(s: string): string;
    htmlEntityDecode(s: string): string;
    pad(s: string, len: number, padChar?: string, side?: "left" | "right" |
"both"): string;
    lpad(s: string, len: number, padChar?: string): string;
    rpad(s: string, len: number, padChar?: string): string;
    sprintf(fmt: string, ...args: unknown[]): string;
    printf(fmt: string, ...args: unknown[]): void;
    normalizeNewlines(s: string, style: "lf" | "crlf" | "cr"): string;
  };

  path: {
    dirname(p: string): string;
  };
};

```

```

    basename(p: string, suffix?: string): string;
};

hash: {
    md5(data: string): string;
    sha1(data: string): string;
    sha256(data: string): string;
    sha384(data: string): string;
    sha512(data: string): string;
    sha3_256(data: string): string;
    sha3_512(data: string): string;
    blake3(data: string): string;
    crc32(data: string): string;
};

compression: {
    algos(): string[];
    compress(
        algo: "gzip" | "deflate" | "zlib" | "bzip2" | "zstd" | "brotli" |
        "lz4" | "xz" | "snappy",
        data: string | ArrayBuffer | Uint8Array,
    ): Promise<Uint8Array>;
    decompress(
        algo: "gzip" | "deflate" | "zlib" | "bzip2" | "zstd" | "brotli" |
        "lz4" | "xz" | "snappy",
        data: string | ArrayBuffer | Uint8Array,
    ): Promise<Uint8Array>;
};

barcode: {
    formats(): string[];
    encode(
        format: "qr" | "datamatrix" | "aztec" | "pdf417"
            | "code128" | "code39" | "codabar"
            | "ean13" | "ean8" | "upca",
        data: string,
        opts?: { width?: number; height?: number },
    ): Promise<Uint8Array>;
};

text: {
    detect(data: string | ArrayBuffer | Uint8Array): Promise<{
        charset: string;
        confidence: number;
        language?: string;
        candidates: Array<{ charset: string; confidence: number; language?:
string }>;
    }>;
    decode(data: string | ArrayBuffer | Uint8Array, charset: string):

```

```

Promise<string>;
    encode(text: string, charset: string): Promise<Uint8Array>;
};

checkdigit: {
    algos(): string[];
    validate(
        algo: "luhn" | "isbn10" | "isbn13" | "ean13" | "ean8" | "upca",
        input: string,
    ): boolean;
    compute(
        algo: "luhn" | "isbn10" | "isbn13" | "ean13" | "ean8" | "upca",
        partial: string,
    ): string;
    inspect(
        algo: "luhn" | "isbn10" | "isbn13" | "ean13" | "ean8" | "upca",
        input: string,
    ): {
        algo: string;
        input: string;
        valid: boolean;
        given: string;
        computed: string;
    };
};

archive: {
    create(
        destPath: string,
        sources: Array<string | { path: string; name?: string }>,
    ): Promise<{ path: string; format: string; entries: string[]; bytes?:
number }>;
    extract(
        archivePath: string,
        destDir: string,
        opts?: { overwrite?: boolean },
    ): Promise<{ path: string; format: string; dest: string; entries:
string[] }>;
};

diff: {
    compare(
        a: string | ArrayBuffer | Uint8Array,
        b: string | ArrayBuffer | Uint8Array,
        opts?: { context?: number; fromFile?: string; toFile?: string },
    ): Promise<{
        identical: boolean;
        binary: boolean;
        added: number;

```

```

        removed: number;
        diff: string;
        format: "unified";
    }>;
};

jq: {
    query(data: unknown, filter: string): Promise<unknown>;
    queryAll(data: unknown, filter: string): Promise<unknown[]>;
};

net: {
    tcp(target: string, opts?: { timeout?: number; port?: string }):
Promise<{
        host: string; port: number; ip: string; latencyMs: number;
    }>;
    dns(host: string, opts?: { types?: ("a" | "aaaa" | "mx" | "txt" |
"cname" | "ns")[] }): Promise<{
        a?: string[]; aaaa?: string[];
        mx?: { preference: number; host: string }[];
        txt?: string[]; cname?: string; ns?: string[];
    }>;
    tls(target: string, opts?: { timeout?: number }): Promise<{
        cn: string; issuer: string;
        notBefore: string; notAfter: string;
        daysRemaining: number;
        dnsNames: string[];
        serialNumber: string;
        fingerprintSha256: string;
    }>;
    ntp(host: string, opts?: { timeout?: number; port?: number }):
Promise<{
        serverTime: string;
        offsetMs: number;
        rttMs: number;
        stratum: number;
        referenceTime: string;
        rootDelayMs: number;
        rootDispersionMs: number;
    }>;
    whois(domain: string, opts?: { timeout?: number }): Promise<{
        raw: string;
        domain?: {
            name: string; punycode?: string;
            whoisServer?: string;
            nameServers?: string[]; status?: string[];
            dnssec?: boolean;
            createDate?: string; updatedAt?: string; expirationDate?:
string;

```

```

    };
    registrar?: { name?: string };
  }>;
};

exec: {
  shell(
    cmd: string | string[],
    opts?: {
      cwd?: string;
      env?: Record<string, string>;
      timeout?: number; // ms; default 30000
      stdin?: string;
    },
  ): Promise<{
    stdout: string;
    stderr: string;
    exitCode: number;
    success: boolean;
    durationMs: number;
  }>;
  http(
    method: string,
    url: string,
    opts?: {
      headers?: Record<string, string>;
      body?: string;
      timeout?: number; // ms; default 30000
      follow?: boolean; // -L
      insecure?: boolean; // -k
      backend?: "auto" | "recon" | "curl"; // default "auto"
    },
  ): Promise<{
    status: number;
    headers: Record<string, string>;
    body: string;
    durationMs: number;
    backend: "recon" | "curl";
  }>;
};

git: {
  branch(opts?: { cwd?: string }): Promise<{
    current: string; // branch name; empty on detached HEAD
    detached: boolean;
    all: string[]; // local branches
  }>;
  isClean(opts?: { cwd?: string }): Promise<boolean>;
  revParse(rev: string, opts?: { cwd?: string }): Promise<string>;

```

```

status(opts?: { cwd?: string }): Promise<Array<{
  path: string;
  indexStatus: string;      // single-char porcelain code
  workingStatus: string;
}>>;
add(paths: string | string[], opts?: { cwd?: string }): Promise<{
paths: string[] }>;
commit(message: string, opts?: { cwd?: string; allowEmpty?: boolean }):
Promise<{ sha: string }>;
log(opts?: { cwd?: string; limit?: number; revRange?: string }):
Promise<Array<{
  sha: string;
  shortSha: string;
  author: string;
  email: string;
  timestamp: number;        // unix seconds
  subject: string;
}>>;
diffStat(opts?: { cwd?: string; revRange?: string }): Promise<{
  files: number;
  insertions: number;
  deletions: number;
}>;
runText(args: string[], opts?: { cwd?: string }): Promise<{
  stdout: string;
  stderr: string;
  exitCode: number;         // surfaced as data – does NOT throw
}>;
};

gh: {
  authStatus(): Promise<{
    authenticated: boolean;
    user: string;           // login or empty
    raw: string;            // login on success, stderr / probe note
on failure
  }>;
  prList(opts?: {
    cwd?: string;
    state?: "open" | "closed" | "merged" | "all";
    limit?: number;         // default 30
    author?: string;
  }): Promise<Array<{
    number: number;
    title: string;
    state: string;
    author: string;         // login (flattened from gh's wrapper)
    headRefName: string;
    baseRefName: string;

```

```

    url: string;
    createdAt: string;
    updatedAt: string;
  }>>;
  repoView(
    repo?: string,           // "owner/name"; omit to use cwd's repo
    opts?: { cwd?: string },
  ): Promise<{
    name: string;
    owner: string;           // login (flattened)
    description: string;
    url: string;
    defaultBranch: string;   // flattened from defaultBranchRef.name
    visibility: string;
  }>;
};

email: {
  spf(domain: string): Promise<
    | { present: false }
    | {
      present: true;
      record: string;
      mechanisms: string[];
      allPolicy: "pass" | "fail" | "softfail" | "neutral" | "";
    }
  >;
  dmarc(domain: string): Promise<
    | { present: false }
    | {
      present: true;
      record: string;
      tags: Record<string, string>;
      policy?: string;
      subdomain?: string;
      percent?: string;
      rua?: string;
      ruf?: string;
    }
  >;
  mtaSts(domain: string): Promise<
    | { present: false }
    | {
      present: true;
      record: string;
      txt: { v: string; id: string };
      policy?: {
        version?: string;
        mode?: "enforce" | "testing" | "none" | string;

```

```

        mx?: string[];
        maxAge?: number | string;
    };
    policyError?: string;
}
>;
tlsRpt(domain: string): Promise<
| { present: false }
| {
    present: true;
    record: string;
    tags: Record<string, string>;
    rua?: string;
}
>;
bimi(domain: string, opts?: { selector?: string }): Promise<
| { present: false; selector: string }
| {
    present: true;
    selector: string;
    record: string;
    tags: Record<string, string>;
    l?: string;
    a?: string;
}
>;
all(domain: string): Promise<{
    domain: string;
    spf:    unknown;
    dmarc:  unknown;
    mtaSts: unknown;
    tlsRpt: unknown;
    bimi:   unknown;
}>;
};
};

```

Examples:


```

api.log("hello", 1 + 2);
api.assert.equal(api.time.nowMs() > 0, true);

const r = await api.http.get("https://example.com");
api.assert.ok(r.status === 200, `expected 200, got ${r.status}`);

await api.time.sleep(50);
const home = api.env.get("HOME") ?? "(none)";

api.log(api.hash.sha256("abc"));
// → ba7816bf8f01cfea414140de5dae2223b00361a396177a9cb410ff61f20015ad

```

HTTP bindings use `net/http` with a 5-second default per-request timeout and surface real `Promise<...>` values through the event loop. They are *not* mockable from JS — they go to the real network.

Compression bindings (`api.compression.*`) cover nine pure-Go algorithms behind a uniform interface. Inputs are either strings (interpreted as UTF-8 byte sequences) or any `ArrayBuffer` / `Uint8Array`; outputs are `Uint8Array` — goja's representation of a Go `[]byte` return is a `Uint8Array`, so scripts can read `.length` and iterate directly without an `ArrayBuffer` view. Every algorithm round-trips:

Algorithm	Library
<code>gzip</code> / <code>deflate</code> / <code>zlib</code>	<code>stdlib compress/*</code>
<code>bzip2</code>	<code>stdlib compress/bzip2</code> for read; github.com/dsnet/compress/bzip2 for write
<code>zstd</code>	github.com/klauspost/compress/zstd
<code>brotli</code>	github.com/andybalholm/brotli
<code>lz4</code>	github.com/pierrec/lz4/v4
<code>xz</code>	github.com/ulikunitz/xz
<code>snappy</code>	github.com/golang/snappy

`api.compression.algos()` returns the supported names so scripts can iterate without hard-coding the list. Unknown algorithm names throw a clear error rather than silently returning empty bytes.

Barcode encoders (`api.barcode.*`) cover ten symbologies through one `encode(format, data, opts?)` entry point, all backed by the pure-Go github.com/boombuler/barcode toolkit. Output is a PNG payload as `Uint8Array`; size defaults to `256x256` for 2D codes (QR / DataMatrix / Aztec) and `400x120` for linear ones, overridable via `opts.width` / `opts.height`.

- 2D: `qr` (medium error correction, auto mode), `datamatrix`, `aztec` (33% ECC, auto layers), `pdf417` (security level 5).
- Linear: `code128`, `code39` (Mod-43 checksum, ASCII-only), `codabar`.
- Retail: `ean13`, `ean8`, `upca` — content must be numeric and the right length; `boombuler/ean.Encode` dispatches by length so all three variants share the same encoder.

`api.barcode.formats()` returns the supported names. A separate cut will add a scanner (QR / DataMatrix / 1D decode from PNG/JPEG via `makiuchi-d/gozxing`).

Charset bindings (`api.text.*`) cover detection plus byte-side round-tripping:

- **`detect(data)`** — runs `saintfish/chardet` over the input and returns the top guess (`charset`, `confidence` on a 0–100 scale, optional `language` hint) plus the full candidate list. Input is bytes (string, `ArrayBuffer`, or `Uint8Array`).
- **`encode(text, charset)`** — converts a UTF-8 string to bytes in the target encoding. Characters with no representation in the target encoding cause the encoder to error out rather than silently lose them; pre-process the input yourself if you want lossy behaviour.
- **`decode(data, charset)`** — the inverse: bytes-in-charset → UTF-8 string.

Charset names follow the WHATWG Encoding Living Standard aliases that

`golang.org/x/text/encoding/htmlindex.Get` accepts — UTF-8, ISO-8859-1, Windows-1252, Shift_JIS, GBK, GB18030, Big5, EUC-JP, EUC-KR, etc., plus all documented aliases. Unknown names throw a clear error.

Check-digit bindings (`api.checkdigit.*`) verify and compute the trailing check digit of common numeric codes. All three members are synchronous — the algorithms are small bits of modular arithmetic, no I/O or library dependency. Supported algorithms (returned by `algorithms()`):

Algorithm	Input length	Notes
<code>luhn</code>	any ≥ 2	Credit cards, IMEI, social-security-style IDs. Mod-10 with right-to-left doubling.
<code>isbn10</code>	10	Last position may be X (= 10). Mod-11 with weighted sum.
<code>isbn13</code>	13	Alias of <code>ean13</code> — same algorithm; the 978 / 979 prefix is the only thing that distinguishes ISBN-13 syntactically.
<code>ean13</code>	13	Mod-10, weights 1, 3, 1, 3, ... from position 0.
<code>ean8</code>	8	Mod-10, weights 3, 1, 3, 1, ...
<code>upca</code>	12	Mod-10, weights 3, 1, 3, 1, ...

`validate(algo, input)` returns a plain boolean — non-digit characters, wrong length, and unknown algorithm names all surface as `false` so scripts can run quick presence checks without try/catch. `compute(algo, partial)` takes the input *without* its check digit and

returns just that digit (or "X" for ISBN-10 position 10). `inspect(algo, input)` returns the union of both views — useful when you want to display the diagnosis to a human.

Archive bindings (`api.archive.*`) handle the three formats `stdlib` provides without external deps: `.zip`, `.tar`, and `.tar.gz` (also `.tgz`). Format is inferred from the destination's extension on `create` and from the source path on `extract`.

- **`create(destPath, sources)`** — `sources` is an array of either bare paths (the basename is used as the in-archive name) or `{ path, name }` objects (override the in-archive name). Directory sources are recursed; the directory's basename becomes the archive subdir and the rest of the tree is added relative to it. Returns the count + list of entries and the output file size.
- **`extract(archivePath, destDir, opts?)`** — unpacks into `destDir`. `opts.overwrite` (default `false`) controls whether existing files at the destination are clobbered; on `false` a collision errors out (`os.ErrExist`-shaped). Every entry name is run through a zip-slip / tar-slip guard that rejects absolute paths, `..` segments, and anything that would resolve outside `destDir`.

Diff bindings (`api.diff.compare(a, b, opts?)`) produce a unified diff between two text inputs via github.com/pmezard/go-difflib. Inputs are strings (UTF-8) or any byte sequence (`ArrayBuffer` / `Uint8Array`). The result reports:

- `identical` — byte-equal inputs short-circuit; `diff` is empty.
- `binary` — either input has a NUL byte in its first 8 KB. A unified diff of binary content isn't useful so `diff` is empty.
- `added` / `removed` — body-only `+` / `-` line counts (file headers are excluded so the numbers match `git diff --shortstat`).
- `diff` — the unified diff text, or empty when `identical` or `binary` is `true`.
- `format` — always `"unified"` today; reserved for future alternatives (`"side-by-side"`, `"summary"`, ...).

`opts.context` (default 3) is the context-line count; `opts.fromFile` / `opts.toFile` (default `"a"` / `"b"`) set the labels in the diff headers.

JSON-query bindings (`api.jq.*`) run jq filters over JS data via github.com/itchyny/gojq, a pure-Go re-implementation. The filter syntax is the same as command-line jq.

- **`query(data, filter)`** — runs the filter and returns the first emitted value (or `null` when the filter emits nothing).
- **`queryAll(data, filter)`** — drains the result iterator and returns every emitted value as an array.

Data passes through goja's `Export` as `map[string]any` / `[]any` trees, which `gojq`'s runtime accepts directly. There's a small normalisation pass on the way in that converts all sized integer types (`int64`, `int32`, etc.) to plain `int` and `float32` to `float64` — `gojq`'s arithmetic dispatch only knows the two canonical numeric kinds, and goja exports every JS-side integer as `int64`. Without normalisation a query as simple as `.users[].age` would panic in `gojq`.

Parse errors and runtime errors (type mismatches, division by zero, ...) both surface as JS exceptions. Use jq's optional access operator `?` (e.g. `.does.not.exist?`) to suppress missing-path errors and get `null` back instead.

Subprocess bindings (`api.exec.*`) wrap Go's `os/exec`. `shell` is the only entry today; `http` (recon-with-curl-fallback) and `git / gh` wrappers ride on top of it in later 0.4.x cuts.

- **`shell(cmd, opts?)`** — runs a subprocess and waits for it to exit. `cmd` is either a **string** (passed verbatim to `/bin/sh -c` on Unix or `cmd /C` on Windows so pipes, redirects, and globs work as typed) or a **string[]** (treated as `argv`, no shell — use this when arguments could be re-interpreted by the shell). Returns `{ stdout, stderr, exitCode, success, durationMs }`.

Options: `cwd` sets the working directory; `env` is merged on top of the parent process environment (not a replacement); `timeout` is in milliseconds and defaults to **30 000 ms**; `stdin` is piped to the child's standard input.

Process-start failures (host binary not on PATH, permission denied) throw. Context deadline (`timeout`) and engine cancellation throw too — the subprocess never got to choose its own exit code, so it isn't reasonable to surface a fake one. Non-zero exits do **not** throw: `success: false` + the real `exitCode` is what callers want for the usual "ran the linter, expected to be told it failed" flow.

- **`http(method, url, opts?)`** — curl-compatible HTTP client routed through `recon` (preferred) with `curl` as a fallback. Returns `{ status, headers, body, durationMs, backend }`. The choice between the two binaries is normally invisible to scripts — both implement the same curl-style flag set we use here (`-X`, `-H`, `-D`, `--data-binary`, `-L`, `-k`, `-s`). Pick a specific backend with `opts.backend: "recon" | "curl"` when you need to.

Implementation notes: response headers are dumped to a temp file via `-D <path>` and parsed back, rather than relying on `-i`'s body-stream format (recon's `-i` is verbose-debug style with `<` prefixes, incompatible with curl's wire-format `-i`). Request bodies are materialised to a temp file and passed via `--data-binary @<path>` so CR / LF are preserved regardless of backend. Header names in the returned map are lower-cased. On redirect chains (`opts.follow: true`), the *last* response wins — the intermediate 3xx blocks are skipped.

HTTP 4xx / 5xx do **not** throw — they're a normal HTTP outcome and callers branch on `status`. Process-start failures, transport errors (DNS, connection refused, TLS handshake), and context deadline / cancellation throw. The error message includes the backend's `stderr` when present.

Git bindings (`api.git.*`) shell out to the host `git` binary; no pure-Go alternative (`go-git` is heavier and would drift from the user's installed git). Every binding accepts an `opts.cwd` so a single engine can work across multiple checkouts.

- **branch(opts?)** — Reports the current branch (empty string when HEAD is detached) plus every local branch from `for-each-ref refs/heads`. `detached` is true exactly when `symbolic-ref --short HEAD` exited non-zero, which is git's own signal for the state.
- **isClean(opts?)** — Convenience boolean over `git status --porcelain`. True when the porcelain output is empty.
- **revParse(rev, opts?)** — Returns the 40-char SHA for `rev`. Invalid refs throw with git's stderr message included.
- **status(opts?)** — Parses `--porcelain v1` output into `{ path, indexStatus, workingStatus }`. The two single-char status codes are the raw porcelain codes (M, A, D, R, ?, ...) so scripts can dispatch on them without re-parsing strings.
- **add(paths, opts?)** — Stages one path (string) or a list (string[]). `--` is inserted between `add` and the paths so values that look like flags work too. Returns the resolved paths array.
- **commit(message, opts?)** — Creates a new commit; the post-commit HEAD SHA is returned. `allowEmpty:true` toggles `--allow-empty`. An empty message throws before spawning.
- **log(opts?)** — Returns `limit` (default 50) most-recent commits in `revRange` (default HEAD). Format string `%H%x09%h%x09%an%x09%ae%x09%at%x09%s` tab-separates SHA, short SHA, author name, email, unix timestamp, and subject. Newlines and tabs in subjects are already collapsed by git so the parse stays one-line-per-commit.
- **diffStat(opts?)** — Aggregates `git diff --shortstat` into `{ files, insertions, deletions }`. Default range is `HEAD~1..HEAD`. A pure-add or pure-delete diff returns zero for the missing side instead of throwing.
- **runText(args, opts?)** — Escape hatch. Surfaces `{ stdout, stderr, exitCode }` for any `git <args>` invocation. Non-zero exits do **not** throw — that's the whole point of having a generic wrapper; callers branch on `exitCode`. Spawn failures and context cancellation still throw.

GitHub-CLI bindings (`api.gh.*`) wrap the `gh` binary. They respect whatever authentication state `gh auth` is already in; we don't try to swap accounts or manage tokens. Every call uses `gh --json` so the result is structured rather than parsed out of human-readable text.

- **authStatus()** — Probe whether `gh` is installed *and* authenticated. Under the hood this runs `gh api user --jq .login` (machine-friendly: just the login on success, a clear error otherwise) rather than `gh auth status` (multi-line human report). Missing-`gh` and unauthenticated-session both resolve with `{ authenticated: false, ... }` rather than throwing — the whole point of a status probe is that the script branches on it. Only context cancellation throws.
- **prList(opts?)** — Lists pull requests on the repo identified by `opts.cwd` (or the engine's working directory). Defaults: open state, limit 30. `gh`'s `author: { login, ... }` wrapper is flattened to just the login string so scripts can compare directly.
- **repoView(repo?, opts?)** — Returns metadata about a repo. With no argument it asks `gh` about the `cwd`'s repo (works from inside a checkout); pass `"owner/name"` to look up any repo `gh` has access to. Two convenience flattenings are applied: `owner` is a

login string (not `{login, ...}`), and `defaultBranch` is the branch name (not `defaultBranchRef.name`). Empty repos resolve with `defaultBranch: ""` rather than `undefined`.

Hash bindings interpret the input as a UTF-8 byte sequence and return lowercase hex. SHA-3 functions are `sha3_256` / `sha3_512` (the IETF spec uses the underscore so the JS name matches recon's). BLAKE3 uses the upstream `lukechampine.com/blake3` reference implementation with a 32-byte output. `crc32` is the IEEE polynomial, zero-padded to 8 hex chars.

String utilities (`api.str.*`) follow PHP-/recon-style semantics where they differ from JS:

- `trim` / `ltrim` / `rtrim` accept an optional mask string; **any character in the mask** is stripped. Default mask is whitespace (`" \t\n\r\v\f"`).
- `reverse` is rune-aware, so `reverse("café")` is `"éfac"`. Grapheme clusters are not handled — that's a separate problem.
- `nl2br` emits `<br>` by default; pass `true` as the second arg for XHTML-style `<br/>`.
- `urlencode` / `urldecode` use the form encoding (`+` for space). For path-segment encoding, use `encodeURIComponent` instead — that one is provided by goja natively.
- `pad` / `lpad` / `rpadd` follow recon's `str_pad`: `pad` defaults to side `"right"`; `"left"` and `"both"` are also accepted.
- `sprintf` / `printf` are thin wrappers over Go's `fmt`, so the verb set is Go's (`%s`, `%d`, `%x`, `%.2f`, `%v`, `%t`, `%q`, etc.) — not PHP's. `printf` writes to `stdout`.
- `normalizeNewlines` canonicalises any mix of `\r\n`, `\r`, and `\n` to the requested style.

Path utilities (`api.path.*`) are POSIX (forward-slash). On Windows either pass forward-slash paths or convert separators yourself.

Time formatting (`api.time.format(unixMs, fmt, tz?)`) takes Unix milliseconds (symmetric with `api.time.nowMs()`) and a small strftime token set: `%Y %y %m %d %H %M %S %F %T %j %A %a %B %b %z %Z %%`. Day and month names are in English. Pass a third-argument IANA zone name (e.g. `"UTC"`, `"America/New_York"`) to render in that zone; if omitted, the host's `time.Local` is used. Unknown `%X` tokens are emitted verbatim so a typo is visible rather than silently dropped.

Protocol probes (`api.net.*`) are stdlib-backed and hit the real network. All three return Promises (via `PromisifyAsync`) and accept an optional `{ timeout: <ms> }` second arg; the default is 5 seconds.

- **`tcp(target, opts?)`** — dials TCP, measures round-trip from resolution to handshake. `target` is `"host:port"` or just `"host"` (with `opts.port` overriding the default `80`). Resolves to the remote IP, port, and `latencyMs`.
- **`dns(host, opts?)`** — looks up A, AAAA, MX, TXT, CNAME, and NS records via `net.Resolver`. Pass `opts.types` to scope the query; empty record sets are omitted from the result object so scripts can probe membership with `if ("mx" in result)`.

- **tls(target, opts?)** — connects with `InsecureSkipVerify` so even expired or hostname-mismatched certs come back inspectable. Returns the leaf cert's CN, issuer CN, validity window, `daysRemaining`, `dnsNames`, serial number, and a SHA-256 fingerprint (lowercase hex). Default port is `443`. Hosts that care about validity should re-validate the cert themselves.
- **ntp(host, opts?)** — queries an NTPv4 server (UDP `123` by default) via github.com/beevik/ntp. Returns the server time (ISO 8601), local-clock offset, round-trip time, stratum, reference time, and the root delay / dispersion values from the server's response. All durations are in milliseconds with sub-millisecond precision.
- **whois(domain, opts?)** — two-hop WHOIS lookup (IANA → registrar's whois server) via github.com/likexian/whois with parsing through github.com/likexian/whois-parser. `raw` is always populated; `domain` and `registrar` are best-effort parsed views (some TLDs the parser doesn't understand will return only `raw`). The whois library doesn't accept a `context.Context` — `opts.timeout` is plumbed through its own per-client setting and the engine's `Options.Timeout` watchdog catches the outer call.

Email-authentication probes (`api.email.*`) read DNS records and surface the published policy. They all return `{ present: false }` when the relevant record is absent (NXDOMAIN or no TXT record matching the marker prefix), so scripts can write a single presence-check pattern across the family.

- **spf(domain)** — queries `TXT(<domain>)` and returns the first record starting with `v=spf1`. `mechanisms` is the tokenised sequence after the version prefix; `allPolicy` summarises the trailing `all` qualifier ("`pass`" for `all` / `+all`, "`fail`" for `-all`, "`softfail`" for `~all`, "`neutral`" for `?all`, empty string when no `all` is present).
- **dmARC(domain)** — queries `TXT(_dmarc.<domain>)` and parses the `v=DMARC1; key=val; ...` form into a flat tag map (keys are case-folded; values retain internal whitespace and commas). `policy` / `subdomain` / `percent` / `rua` / `ruf` are surfaced separately because those are the fields most scripts care about.
- **mtaSts(domain)** — looks up `TXT(_mta-sts.<domain>)` and, on success, fetches the policy file at `https://mta-sts.<domain>/.well-known/mta-sts.txt`. The TXT carries a versioned `id` for change detection; the policy file is where the actual `mode` + `mx` list live. RFC 8461 format (line-based, `key: value`, `mx:` repeats) is parsed inline. Policy-fetch failures (TLS errors, 4xx, timeout) don't fail the binding — the TXT part is still returned, and the fetch error surfaces under `policyError` so scripts can decide what to do.
- **tlsRpt(domain)** — looks up `TXT(_smtp._tls.<domain>)` and parses the `v=TLSRPTv1; rua=...` form into a tag map. `rua` is surfaced separately because that's the actionable bit.
- **bimi(domain, opts?)** — looks up `<selector>._bimi.<domain>`, selector defaulting to `default`. Surfaces the logo URL (`l`) and VMC URL (`a`) from the tag map.

- `all(domain)` — runs every probe above in parallel via goroutines and returns a single aggregate object keyed by probe name. Per-probe failures don't fail the aggregate — they surface under `<probe>.error` so a partial result is still useful (e.g. SPF + DMARC found, MTA-STS policy fetch timed out).

6. JavaScript runtime built-ins (goja)

`scriptengine` runs on goja, which implements **ES5.1 + a large subset of ES6+**. The following are present and behave per spec:

Globals

- `Object`, `Array`, `String`, `Number`, `Boolean`, `BigInt`
- `Math`, `Date`, `JSON`, `RegExp`
- `Error`, `TypeError`, `RangeError`, `SyntaxError`, `ReferenceError`, `EvalError`, `URIError`
- `Promise` (provided via goja's native implementation; resolution microtasks are pumped by the event loop)
- `Symbol` (partial: well-known symbols `Symbol.iterator`, `Symbol.asyncIterator`, etc., are supported)
- `Proxy`, `Reflect` (partial)

```
api.log(Math.PI.toFixed(4), Math.max(1, 9, 3));
api.log(new Date().toISOString());
api.log(JSON.stringify({ a: 1, b: [2, 3] }));
api.log("abc".repeat(3), "abc".padStart(6, "_"));
```

Collections

- `Map`, `Set`, `WeakMap`, `WeakSet`

```
const counts = new Map<string, number>();
for (const ch of "banana") counts.set(ch, (counts.get(ch) ?? 0) + 1);
api.log([...counts]); // [{"b",1}, {"a",3}, {"n",2}]
```

Typed arrays

- `ArrayBuffer`, `DataView`
- `Int8Array`, `Uint8Array`, `Uint8ClampedArray`, `Int16Array`, `Uint16Array`, `Int32Array`, `Uint32Array`, `Float32Array`, `Float64Array`


```
const buf = new ArrayBuffer(4);
new DataView(buf).setUint32(0, 0xCAFEBAFE);
api.log(new Uint8Array(buf)[0].toString(16)); // ca
```

Iteration and generators

- `for...of`, `for...in`, `spread`, `destructuring`
- Generator functions (`function*`)
- Async generators (`async function*`) — supported via goja's event loop

```
function* fib() {
  let [a, b] = [0, 1];
  while (true) {
    yield a;
    [a, b] = [b, a + b];
  }
}
const it = fib();
const first10 = Array.from({ length: 10 }, () => it.next().value);
api.log(first10);
```

Not (yet) provided

- `fetch` — use `api.http.*` from the CLI, or register your own binding.
- `Worker`, `threading` primitives.
- DOM globals (`window`, `document`).
- Native ES modules (`import` / `export` are *transpiled* to CommonJS at load time — see [section 8](#)).

7. Async runtime additions (goja_nodejs)

The event loop bundles a small Node-compatible runtime on top of goja:

Timers

```
setTimeout(() => api.log("after 50ms"), 50);
setInterval(() => api.log("tick"), 100);
setImmediate(() => api.log("next tick"));
clearTimeout(t); clearInterval(i); clearImmediate(im);
```

The event loop holds the script alive while *any* timer is pending. If your script ends with only `setTimeout` callbacks scheduled, the run will wait for them to fire before returning.

console

```
console.log("info");
console.error("oops");
console.warn("careful");
console.info("fyi");
console.debug("trace");
```

Disable with `Options.DisableConsole = true` if you want a clean global namespace.

require

CommonJS `require`, with TS-aware extension fallback added by `sercon` (see [section 10](#)):

```
const helpers = require("./helpers");
helpers.doThing();
```

Both `require("./foo")` and `import { x } from "./foo"` resolve to the same module instance per Run; esbuild rewrites `import` to `require` at transpile time.

8. TypeScript support

TS is transpiled by esbuild in-process. There is no `tsc`, no `tsconfig.json`, no type-checking — types are erased and the resulting JS is what executes. Practical implications:

- All TS syntax esbuild supports is allowed: type annotations, `interface`, `type`, generics, enums (compiled to objects), namespaces, decorators (legacy & TC39 stage 3).
- `import type { X } from "y"` is stripped entirely (no runtime require).
- TS errors are *not* surfaced as build errors — only esbuild parse errors are. Run a separate `tsc --noEmit` in CI if you want type enforcement.
- `tsconfig.json` is **not** consulted.

`.tsx` and `.jsx` are supported via esbuild's `LoaderTSX` / `LoaderJSX`, including for required modules resolved by the engine's extension fallback. JSX has no React runtime in scope by default — either set the factory at the file level with an `@jsx` pragma:

```
/** @jsx h */
function h(tag: string, props: any, ...children: any[]) {
  return { tag, props: props ?? {}, children };
}
export const Box = (label: string) => <div className="box">{label}</div>;
```

...or provide a `React.createElement`-compatible binding from Go and rely on esbuild's default pragma. ESM `export default <value>` also works through the entry-script rewriter's

`__esModule ? .default : m` unwrap, so `import answer from "./mod"` resolves to the default export.

9. Top-level `await`

Top-level `await` works in entry scripts:

```
const r = await api.http.get("https://example.com");
api.log(r.status);
```

How it works under the hood: esbuild rejects top-level `await` with the `cjs` output format, so the engine transpiles the *entry* script with `format=esm`, then rewrites `import` statements to `require()` calls and wraps the rest of the body in:

```
;(async () => { /* your transpiled body */ })().then(__resolve, __reject);
```

`__resolve` and `__reject` are bindings the engine sets on the runtime to capture the final settlement. *Required-module* code (anything loaded through `require`) is transpiled with `format=cjs` and does **not** support top-level `await` — wrap in `(async () => ... )()` yourself if you need it inside a module.

10. Module resolution

The engine plugs a custom source loader into `goja_nodejs/require` that adds:

1. **Direct path**: if the requested file exists on disk, use it. `.ts` / `.tsx` files are transpiled on the fly.
2. **Extension fallback** when the request has no extension: try `.ts`, `.tsx`, `.js`, `.cjs`, `.mjs`, `.json` in that order.
3. **.js → .ts swap**: if a path ending in `.js` / `.cjs` / `.mjs` is requested but the literal file doesn't exist, the same path ending in `.ts` (or `.tsx`) is tried. Handles `package.json` `main` fields that point at compiled output where only the TypeScript source is on disk.
4. **package.json source preference**: when reading a `package.json`, if a `source` field is present and points at an existing `.ts` / `.tsx` file, `main` is rewritten to that path before the registry consumes it. Matches the convention used by parcel, microbundle, and similar bundlers to mark the TS source of truth.
5. **Directory index**: if the resolved path is a directory, try `index.ts`, `index.tsx`, `index.js`.

The base directory follows Node's CommonJS rules — relative imports resolve against the requiring module's directory, courtesy of `goja_nodejs`.

```
// All resolve to ./helpers/assert.ts:
import { check } from "./helpers/assert";
import { check } from "./helpers/assert.ts";
const { check } = require("./helpers/assert");
const { check } = require("./helpers/assert.js");
```

JSON imports work out of the box via either the ESM-style default import (esbuild rewrites it to a `require`) or a direct `require`:

```
import data from "./data.json";
const r = require("./data.json");
```

`node_modules` lookup *works* via the upstream registry, but the source loader doesn't currently transpile through that path — keep TS helpers under `ScriptRoot`.

11. Timeouts and cancellation

Two mechanisms interrupt a running script:

- `Options.Timeout` — wall-clock limit per `Run`. Exceeding it returns `scriptengine.ErrScriptTimeout`.
- `ctx` passed to `Run / RunFile` — cancelling the context returns `ctx.Err()` (typically `context.Canceled` or `context.DeadlineExceeded`).

Both call `vm.Interrupt(...)` and `loop.Terminate()` from a watcher goroutine. This works for **sync** JS — including `while(true){}` — because the goja VM checks the interrupt flag between bytecode steps. A host Go binding that's blocked in cgo or a long syscall isn't interruptible mid-call; if you write such a binding, plumb the engine `ctx` through to it yourself.

```
eng := scriptengine.New(scriptengine.Options{Timeout: 200 *
time.Millisecond})
_, err := eng.Run(ctx, "loop.ts", `while (true) {}`)
// err is scriptengine.ErrScriptTimeout, returned ~200–300ms after Run.
```

12. Error semantics

- A Go binding returning `(T, error)` automatically throws as a JS exception when `err != nil`. The exception's `.message` is `err.Error()`.

```
try { mayFail(); } catch (e) { api.log(String(e)); }
```

- A Go binding that `panic`s with a `*goja.Object` (e.g. `vm.NewGoError(...)`) does the same.

- A script throwing a JS error out of the top level surfaces from `Run` as a Go `error` whose message is the JS error's `.message`.
- Timeout errors satisfy `errors.Is(err, scriptengine.ErrScriptTimeout)`. Cancellation errors satisfy `errors.Is(err, context.Canceled)` or `context.DeadlineExceeded`.

13. Type generation (.d.ts)

`Engine.WriteTypes(w)` walks the registered bindings and emits a TypeScript declaration file. The mapping table (abbreviated):

Go type	TS type
<code>string</code>	<code>string</code>
<code>any numeric / float64</code>	<code>number</code>
<code>bool</code>	<code>boolean</code>
<code>[]T</code>	<code>T[] ; []byte → Uint8Array</code>
<code>map[string]T</code>	<code>Record<string, T></code>
<code>*T</code>	<code>T</code> (transparent unwrap)
<code>error</code> (single return)	omitted (collapses to <code>void</code>)
<code>(T, error)</code> (tuple return)	<code>T</code>
<code>interface{}</code> / <code>any</code>	<code>unknown</code>
<code>goja.FunctionCall</code> parameter	folded into <code>(...args: unknown[])</code>
<code>goja.Value</code> return	<code>unknown</code>
<code>scriptengine.AsyncBinding</code> value (from <code>PromisifyAsync[T]</code>)	<code>Promise<T></code>
self-referential types	<code>unknown</code> (cycle detection bails after depth 4)

```
sercon --emit-dts api.d.ts
```

In your editor, place the resulting `.d.ts` next to your scripts (or reference it via `/// <reference path="..." />`) for autocomplete.

14. Limitations and gotchas

- **No native ES modules at runtime.** All `import` is rewritten to `require` by esbuild. Side-effect-only imports run the module body exactly once per Run.
- **No top-level await inside required modules.** Wrap with `(async () => ... )()` inside the module if you need it.
- **No `tsconfig.json` honoured.** Module resolution and type checking are independent from any project-level TS config.
- **Per-Run runtime.** Side effects on `globalThis` do not persist between calls to `Run` on the same `Engine`. The `require compile` cache is shared; module `exports` are not.
- **Multi-line ESM imports may stress the entry rewriter.** The current rewriter is line-based and handles the common forms; especially gnarly inputs (comments inside the spec list, very unusual whitespace) fall back to executing as-is, which may throw.
- **RegisterConstructor is d.ts-only today.** At runtime it behaves like `Register`. True `new`-able constructor semantics are on the roadmap.
- **HTTP bindings are real network calls.** `api.http.*` uses `net/http` with a 5s timeout. They are not mockable from JS.

See [OUT-OF-SCOPE.md](#) for the active backlog of deferred ideas.

This manual covers sercon v0.4.21. Whenever you add, remove, or change a flag, a binding, or the script API, update this file alongside the help screen (`--help`), the examples walkthrough (`--examples`), and the `CHANGELOG.md`.